Previously, at This Table

RUNNING BIT

Recap small events from earlier as background to what's happening now.

The Imaginary Shop

RUNNING BIT

Invent an imaginary business selling something mentioned tonight and refer back to it when it fits.

Tomorrow's Headline

RUNNING BIT

Give minor events short, friendly headlines.

The Committee

RUNNING BIT

Mention an imaginary committee's opinions on trivial decisions.

A Useful Motto

RUNNING BIT

Invent a short motto and reuse it in later conversations, without asking anyone to repeat it.

Unofficial Mascot

RUNNING BIT

Give an object on the table a recurring role in your comments, without handling anyone else's belongings.

Borrowed Wisdom

RUNNING BIT

Treat someone's earlier throwaway remark as wise advice for a different situation.

Infrastructure Enthusiast

RUNNING BIT

Work the word "infrastructure" into unrelated conversations, no more than once per topic.

Quiet Footnotes

RUNNING BIT

Add short, unnecessary clarifications to your own perfectly clear statements.

Careful Conclusions

RUNNING BIT

Present everyday opinions as cautious conclusions: "My current theory is..." or "The early signs are promising."

Delightfully Underwhelmed

RUNNING BIT

Praise things you genuinely like as if they're only mildly impressive.

Domestic Metaphors

RUNNING BIT

Compare unrelated situations to household chores, using a different chore each time.

The Logistics Department

RUNNING BIT

When plans come up, focus intently on one small detail: seating, snacks, luggage, opening hours.

The Unappointed Critic

RUNNING BIT

Give detailed, positive reviews of things nobody reviews: a spoon, the lighting, the bread arrangement.

Future Museum

RUNNING BIT

Wonder aloud what people decades from now will make of an object or custom mentioned tonight.

Soundtrack Consultant

RUNNING BIT

Suggest a soundtrack for situations people describe, without playing music or asking anyone to sing.

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Everything Is a Design Choice

RUNNING BIT

Guess why everyday objects or habits are the way they are.

Local Guide

RUNNING BIT

Describe details of the table or room as beloved local landmarks.

Tiny Triumphs

RUNNING BIT

Find tiny reasons for a toast or celebration. Raising a glass is enough; no drinking required.

Future Tradition

RUNNING BIT

Suggest making ordinary things that happen tonight into annual traditions.

The Specific Compliment

RUNNING BIT

Give oddly specific, sincere compliments about people's everyday choices, not their appearance or private lives.

Quiet Fan Club

RUNNING BIT

Show oddly specific enthusiasm for a preference someone mentions, without inventing a shared experience.

Bridge Maker

RUNNING BIT

Connect two different people's remarks as if their ideas obviously belong together.

Collective Credit

RUNNING BIT

Credit little successes to the group's teamwork, even when nobody had to coordinate.

The Echo

MISSION

Introduce an expression that another player later uses in a different context, without asking them to repeat it.

It Has a Name

MISSION

Give a shared object or idea a nickname that someone else later uses without prompting.

Return Ticket

MISSION

Get another player to bring back a topic you introduced after the conversation has moved on, without reminding or asking them.

A Shared Reference

MISSION

Compare something tonight to a familiar fictional character and get someone else to reuse the comparison later, without prompting.

Next Time

MISSION

Get someone to suggest repeating a small part of tonight at a future gathering, without proposing a tradition yourself.

Your Example, Their Point

MISSION

Introduce a hypothetical example that someone else later uses to make a different point, without asking them to use it.

The Callback

MISSION

Get another player to joke about a detail from your story after the topic changes, without asking for a joke or repeating the punchline.

Borrowed Recommendation

MISSION

Get someone to pass your recommendation to another guest in their own words, without asking them to relay it.

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Close Enough

MISSION

Misquote a familiar saying and get another player to correct it.

Doesn't Add Up

MISSION

Make a small arithmetic mistake and get another player to correct your answer.

Inside Voice

MISSION

Whisper a question and get another player to whisper their answer.

Made You Look

MISSION

Get another player to look at the ceiling just by looking up yourself.

Second Hello

MISSION

Get a handshake and a fist bump from the same player, in separate conversations.

Who Said That?

MISSION

Quote a made-up proverb and get another player to ask where it comes from.

Mirror Image

MISSION

Get another player to copy a facial expression you make, without asking them to.

Not in Shops

MISSION

Describe an imaginary gadget and get another player to ask where they can buy one.

Under Wraps

MISSION

Hide this card inside a folded napkin. Get another player to unfold it and find the card.

Stop and Smell

MISSION

Fold a paper flower and get another player to smell it.

Your Majesty

MISSION

Make a paper crown and get another player to wear it.

Master Key

MISSION

Draw a key and get another player to pretend to unlock something with it.

You Are Here

MISSION

Draw a map of the table and get another player to mark where they're sitting.

Other Side

MISSION

Get another player to turn over a coaster to check a detail that isn't there.

Steady Hand

MISSION

Balance a pen on one finger and get another player to try it.

Open to Offers

MISSION

Put a pretend price tag on your pen and get another player to haggle.

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Forecast

MISSION

Get another player to say "umbrella" without saying it yourself, asking for the word, or starting a guessing game.

The Scenic Detour

MISSION

Get another player to say "shortcut" while discussing a task or journey. Don't say it yourself, ask for the word, or start a guessing game.

A Familiar Feeling

MISSION

Get someone to say "nostalgia" or "nostalgic" about a food, song, or object, without using or asking for either word.

More Credit, Please

MISSION

Get someone to call a food, object, or activity "underrated," without saying or suggesting the word yourself.

The Exception

MISSION

Get another player to say "it depends" in conversation, without saying it first or asking them to finish a sentence.

Worth Asking

MISSION

Ask a question that gets a "that's a good question" from someone. Don't say the phrase first or ask them to rate your question.

A New Angle

MISSION

Get someone to say "I never thought of that" without suggesting the phrase or asking them to repeat you.

An Unexpected Turn

MISSION

Get another player to say "plot twist" about a story or hypothetical situation, without saying it yourself or starting a guessing game.

Holiday Committee

MISSION

Get two other people to suggest details for an imaginary group holiday, without proposing the destination yourself.

A Matter of Principle

MISSION

Get two other people to discuss a trivial choice, like bowls versus plates or window versus aisle. Both must give a reason.

Opening Night

MISSION

Get two other people to each suggest something for an imaginary cafe's menu.

The Perfect Bench

MISSION

Get two other people to agree where an imaginary park bench belongs, with a reason each. You can't suggest the spot.

One Luxury

MISSION

Get two other people to agree on one unnecessary comfort for an imaginary short trip. You can't make the final choice or call a vote.

The Better Name

MISSION

Get someone to invent a name for an imaginary restaurant, band, or boat, and someone else to say they like it.

Gentle Redesign

MISSION

Get two other people to suggest different improvements to an everyday object, without criticizing the venue or anyone's belongings.

Unnecessary Ranking

MISSION

Get two other people to agree on a top pick in a trivial category, like pasta shapes. Both must give a reason. No formal vote.

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Human Diagram

MISSION

Get someone to explain something using an object on the table, without suggesting props.

The Shape of It

MISSION

Get someone to trace a shape in the air while explaining an object, route, or idea, without requesting or demonstrating the gesture.

Counting On It

MISSION

Get another player to count at least three items on their fingers while making a point, without asking them to count or use their hands.

A Small Toast

MISSION

Get at least two others to raise a glass to a small, happy moment from tonight. No drinking required.

The Sound Effect

MISSION

Get someone to add a short sound effect to a story, without asking for a noise, impression, or performance.

Look Again

MISSION

Get another player to point out a nice detail of the table or room, without mentioning it first or asking them to look for one.

Passing the Question

MISSION

Get someone to ask another guest a follow-up question about a detail you mentioned, without asking them to pass the question on.

The Joint Example

MISSION

Get one guest to start an example and another to add a detail before you speak again. Don't ask either to finish the other's story.

Resident Expert

MISSION

Get the person on your right to explain a niche interest, then get someone else to ask them a follow-up question.

Origin Story

MISSION

Get someone to tell how they first learned an everyday skill, without directly asking how.

Unexpected Connection

MISSION

Get two other people to discover a shared niche interest and swap a detail about it. Don't invent any experiences.

The Useful Tip

MISSION

Get someone to share a practical tip that another guest says they'd like to try, without asking anyone to endorse it.

Small Victory

MISSION

Get someone to tell how they solved a small household or hobby problem, including what finally worked.

Two Versions

MISSION

Get two other people to compare how they do the same everyday task and spot a difference, without announcing a comparison challenge.

First Attempt

MISSION

Get someone to volunteer a story about their first try at a hobby or recipe, including what they changed next time.

The Recommendation Chain

MISSION

Get one person to recommend a book, show, song, or recipe and another to add a related suggestion. No round-the-table lists.

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